

Government Rallies to Ensure Tourist Safety and Support Amid Cyclone Challenges

Cyclone Ditwah to move away from Sri Lanka today

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The hospitality industry in Sri Lanka is facing significant challenges due to the adverse weather conditions caused by Cyclone Ditwah. The tourism sector, which is a major contributor to the country's economy, has been severely impacted, with many tourist attractions and accommodations affected by flooding and landslides.

Colombo | November 29 | Coastal areas such as Mirissa, Unawatuna, and Galle have been temporarily closed due to the threat of floods and storm surges.

Cultural Heritage Sites: Inland cities like Kandy, known for their temples and tea plantations, have experienced disruptions, with severe rainfall affecting roads and access to key historical sites.

Wildlife and Adventure Tourism: National parks like Yala and Udawalawe have been put on hold.

The Sri Lanka Tourism Development Authority (SLTDA) has assured international visitors that major tourist destinations across the island continue to operate as normal, with hotels, transport services, and tourist attractions functioning without disruption. SLTDA has also set up a 24/7 hotline (1912) to assist visitors affected by the prevailing weather conditions. The Sri Lanka government has activated its Disaster Management Centre (DMC) to provide support to the tourism sector. The Tourist Police have been deployed in key zones to assist travelers on the ground. Emergency hotlines have been introduced for reporting disaster situations in Colombo. It's recommended to monitor official advisories, keep receipts for unexpected costs, and stay in close communication with airlines or tour operators for timely assistance.

The Airport and Aviation Services (Sri Lanka) says several airport access roads have been affected by flooding due to the prevailing adverse weather conditions across the country, advising passengers to use the Colombo - Katunayake Expressway to ensure a smoother and safer journey to the Katunayake Airport.

Cyclone Ditwah Disrupts Flight Arrivals and Departures in Sri Lanka, Travelers Urged to Stay Informed **Colombo, Sri Lanka** – The aviation sector in Sri Lanka has faced significant disruptions as Cyclone Ditwah brings adverse weather conditions to the region. With heavy rains and strong winds battering the island, multiple flights have been canceled or delayed, affecting thousands of travelers. The Sri Lankan Civil Aviation Authority (SLCAA) announced that both international and domestic flights have been impacted, urging passengers to check with their airlines for the latest updates. Major airports, including Bandaranaike International Airport in Colombo, have implemented strict safety measures to ensure the security of travelers and staff. "We are closely monitoring the situation and are working with airlines to minimize disruptions as much as possible," said an SLCAA spokesperson. "The safety of passengers is our top priority, and we recommend that travelers stay updated through official channels."

In addition to cancellations, several flights are experiencing delays, leading to long queues and frustration among passengers. Travelers have been advised to arrive at the airport well in advance and to prepare for potential changes to their travel plans. The government has also deployed emergency response teams to assist stranded tourists and locals alike. Hotels and accommodations in the vicinity of the airport are working with authorities to provide shelter for those in need.

As Cyclone Ditwah continues to affect the island, authorities are urging everyone to stay informed about weather updates and to follow safety guidelines. The Ministry of Tourism has assured tourists that the government is committed to ensuring their safety and well-being during these challenging times. Travelers are encouraged to keep an eye on local news and their airline's communication channels for further developments. As the situation evolves, the hope is that operations will return to normalcy soon, allowing Sri Lanka's vibrant tourism sector to rebound. For more information, travelers can visit the official websites of the Sri Lankan Civil Aviation Authority or their respective airlines.